John 19 - 21

Key Notes, Cross-References, and Prophecy Fulfilled (WEB)

A crown made of thorns. A purple robe. Soldiers slapping Him and calling Him king.

And a Roman governor leading Him out in front of the crowd and saying two words.

Behold, the man.

Zechariah used those words five hundred years earlier. Behold, the man whose name is the Branch, who will build the temple of Yahweh.

Then Behold your King - and the chief priests of Israel shouting back: we have no king but Caesar.

Then a cross carried out of the city, like the wood Isaac carried up the mountain.

A sign over His head in Hebrew, Latin and Greek. Soldiers gambling for a seamless robe. A mother given a son from the cross.

I am thirsty. A sponge of vinegar lifted on a branch of hyssop - the plant that painted the blood on the doorposts in Egypt.

And then one word in Greek. Tetelestai. It is finished.

Not a bone broken, like the Passover lamb. A spear in His side, and blood and water.

And two secret disciples finally coming out into the open to bury Him in a garden.

Then the first day of the week, while it was still dark. A stone rolled away. Grave clothes lying in their place, and the head cloth folded by itself.

A woman weeping in a garden, who thinks the risen Lord is the gardener - until He says her name.

Mary.

Then locked doors, and Him standing in the middle of the room. Peace to you. As the Father sent Me, I send you. And He breathes on them, the way God breathed into Adam.

Then Thomas, a week later, with his hand where the nails were. My Lord and my God.

Then a night of fishing with nothing to show for it, and a voice from the shore at dawn.

Children, have you caught anything?

A hundred and fifty-three fish. A charcoal fire. Breakfast on the beach.

And three questions for the man who denied Him three times. Do you love Me?

Feed My sheep. Follow Me.

This is not just history.

This is a mirror.

And tonight, we let the Word fill us.

CHAPTER 19 - Behold the Man, It Is Finished, and a Tomb in a Garden

Key Notes

- Pilate had Him flogged before any verdict, probably hoping a beating would satisfy the crowd. It did not (John 19:1, 19:4-6).
- The crown was woven from thorns. Thorns came into the world with the curse on the ground in Genesis 3. The one who came to undo the curse wore it on His head (John 19:2, Genesis 3:17-18).
- “Behold, the man!” Pilate means look at him - beaten, harmless, pitiful. Zechariah had said: behold, the man whose name is the Branch, and he shall build Yahweh’s temple. Pilate quoted a prophet without knowing it (John 19:5, Zechariah 6:12).
- “I find no basis for a charge against him” is said for the second and third times here. The Lamb examined by the judge three times, and found without defect (John 19:4, 19:6, 18:38).
- “By our law he ought to die, because he made himself the Son of God.” Now the real charge comes out. Not sedition. Blasphemy (John 19:7, Leviticus 24:16).
- When he heard that, Pilate was more afraid. Romans had stories about sons of gods walking among men. Where are you from? - and Yahshua gives him no answer, as the servant before his shearers was silent (John 19:8-9, Isaiah 53:7).
- “You would have no power at all against me, unless it were given to you from above.” The governor thinks he holds the power. He is told where it comes from (John 19:11).
- “You aren’t Caesar’s friend.” Friend of Caesar was an honored title, and a threat: a governor reported to Rome for freeing a would-be king would lose everything (John 19:12).
- The judgment seat stood on a stone pavement called Gabbatha. John gives both the Greek and the Hebrew name, as an eyewitness would (John 19:13).
- “It was the Preparation Day of the Passover” - the day the lambs were made ready. Mark places the crucifixion at the third hour and John has Pilate’s verdict at about the sixth; whether John counts hours differently or both are approximate, readers have long discussed (John 19:14, Mark 15:25).
- “Behold, your King!” And the chief priests answer: we have no king but Caesar. The men who led the worship of Yahweh rejected Him as King out loud, as Israel did when they asked Samuel for a king like the nations (John 19:14-15, 1 Samuel 8:7).
- “He went out, bearing his cross.” Isaac carried the wood up Moriah on his own back. John does not mention Simon of Cyrene; he wants you to see the Son carrying the wood (John 19:17, Genesis 22:6).
- Golgotha means the place of a skull. It was outside the city, as the sin offering was burned outside the camp (John 19:17, 19:20, Hebrews 13:11-12).
- Two others were crucified with Him, one on each side, and Yahshua in the middle. Numbered with the transgressors, as Isaiah said (John 19:18, Isaiah 53:12).

- The sign read JESUS OF NAZARETH, THE KING OF THE JEWS in Hebrew, Latin and Greek - the language of the covenant, of the empire, and of the wider world. Everybody passing by could read it (John 19:19-20).
- “What I have written, I have written.” Pilate, who could not stand up for the truth, would not change a sign that told it (John 19:22).
- The soldiers split His clothes four ways, and gambled for the seamless tunic, woven from the top in one piece. The robe of the high priest was woven work, made so it would not be torn. The psalm says: they divide my garments among them, and cast lots for my clothing (John 19:23-24, Exodus 28:32, Psalm 22:18).
- Women stood by the cross, and one disciple. Most of the men who had promised to die with Him were gone (John 19:25-26).
- “Woman, behold your son!” The same address He used at Cana. His mother appears at the first sign and at the cross, and at both He calls her woman (John 19:26, 2:4).
- From the cross He provides for His mother. Honor your father and your mother - kept to His last breath (John 19:26-27, Exodus 20:12).
- “I am thirsty.” The one who offered living water at a well and shouted come and drink at the feast, thirsty. In my thirst they gave me vinegar to drink, the psalm says (John 19:28, 4:14, 7:37, Psalm 69:21).
- The sponge was put on hyssop - the plant used to paint the blood of the Passover lamb on the doorposts in Egypt. John alone mentions it (John 19:29, Exodus 12:22).
- “It is finished” is one word in Greek, tetelestai, which could be written on a bill to mean paid in full. It is from the same root as loved them to the end in 13:1 (John 19:30, 13:1).
- “He bowed his head, and gave up his spirit.” He was not overcome. He handed His spirit over. No one took His life from Him (John 19:30, 10:18).
- “That Sabbath was a special one” - in older translations, a high day. That is the language of an annual Sabbath, and the first day of Unleavened Bread was a holy convocation with no regular work. This study reads it that way, which places two Sabbaths in that week and leaves room for three days and three nights in the tomb (John 19:31, Leviticus 23:6-7, Matthew 12:40).
- Bodies were not to hang overnight, because the Torah says a hanged man must be buried the same day. Breaking the legs made death come quickly (John 19:31, Deuteronomy 21:22-23).
- They did not break His legs, because He was already dead. A bone of the Passover lamb was not to be broken (John 19:33, 19:36, Exodus 12:46, Psalm 34:20).
- A soldier pierced His side, and blood and water came out. John stops the story to swear that he saw it - he who has seen has testified, and his testimony is true (John 19:34-35).
- “They will look on him whom they pierced” is Zechariah 12, where Yahweh is speaking: they will look to me whom they have pierced. John quotes it of the man on the cross (John 19:37, Zechariah 12:10).

- Joseph of Arimathea, a secret disciple for fear of the Jews, asks for the body. Nicodemus, who first came by night, comes with him. The cross brought the hidden ones into the open (John 19:38-39).
- A hundred Roman pounds of myrrh and aloes is about seventy-five pounds by our measure - a burial fit for a king. The psalm says all your garments smell of myrrh and aloes (John 19:39, Psalm 45:8, 2 Chronicles 16:14).
- The tomb was new, in a garden, and no one had ever been laid in it. Isaiah said His grave would be with a rich man in His death (John 19:41, Isaiah 53:9, Matthew 27:57).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Thorns and Thistles	John 19:2 • Genesis 3:17-18
He Ought to Die by Our Law	John 19:7 • Leviticus 24:16 • Deuteronomy 18:20
They Have Rejected Me as King	John 19:15 • 1 Samuel 8:7 • Judges 8:23
The Wood Laid on the Son	John 19:17 • Genesis 22:6
Woven So It Would Not Tear	John 19:23 • Exodus 28:31-32 • Exodus 39:22
A Bunch of Hyssop	John 19:29 • Exodus 12:22 • Psalm 51:7
A Special Sabbath	John 19:31 • Leviticus 23:6-7 • Deuteronomy 21:22-23
A New Tomb in a Garden	John 19:41 • Matthew 27:60 • Genesis 2:8

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
Behold, the Man Whose Name Is the Branch	John 19:5 • Zechariah 6:12 • Isaiah 4:2
Silent Before His Shearers	John 19:9 • Isaiah 53:7 • Psalm 38:13-14
Numbered With the Transgressors	John 19:18 • Isaiah 53:12
Lots Cast for His Clothing	John 19:24 • Psalm 22:18
Vinegar for His Thirst	John 19:28 • Psalm 69:21 • Psalm 22:15
Not a Bone Broken	John 19:36 • Exodus 12:46 • Psalm 34:20
Him Whom They Pierced	John 19:37 • Zechariah 12:10
With a Rich Man in His Death	John 19:41 • Isaiah 53:9 • Psalm 45:8

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 19 Commentary (David Guzik) - the trial before Pilate, the crucifixion, and the burial
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 19A - exposition of the crucifixion according to John

John 19 - Opening Intro

This is the chapter every other chapter has been walking toward.

Pilate has Him whipped. The soldiers twist a crown out of thorns and push it onto His head, throw a purple robe on Him, and take turns slapping Him. Hail, King of the Jews.

Thorns. Do you remember where thorns come from? Genesis 3. The ground is cursed because of you. It will grow thorns and thistles. The curse came with thorns. And the One who came to undo the curse wore it on His head.

And Pilate brings Him out in front of the crowd, beaten and bleeding, and says: behold, the man.

He meant: look at Him. Does this look dangerous to you?

But five hundred years earlier the prophet Zechariah had said: behold, the man whose name is the Branch. He will build the temple of Yahweh. And a pagan governor said the prophecy word for word without knowing it.

And the crowd shouts: crucify, crucify. And Pilate says it again. I find no fault in Him. That is three times now. The Lamb examined, and no defect found.

Then the real charge comes out. We have a law, and by that law He ought to die, because He made Himself the Son of God.

And Pilate gets scared. He goes back inside and asks: where are You from? And Yahshua does not say a word. Like a sheep before its shearers is silent.

Pilate says: do You not know I have power to crucify You or release You? And Yahshua says: you would have no power over Me at all unless it had been given to you from above.

Then they play their last card. If you let this man go, you are no friend of Caesar.

And Pilate sits down on the judgment seat. And John tells us the day and the hour. It was the Preparation Day of the Passover. The day the lambs were being made ready.

Behold your King. And the chief priests - the men in charge of the worship of Yahweh - shout: we have no king but Caesar.

That is what Israel did in Samuel's day. Give us a king like the nations. And God said: they have not rejected you, Samuel. They have rejected Me.

And He goes out carrying His own cross. John does not mention anyone helping. He wants you to see what Abraham saw on Mount Moriah - the son carrying the wood up the hill himself.

They crucify Him at the place of the skull, between two others. Numbered with the transgressors.

Pilate has a sign nailed up. Jesus of Nazareth, King of the Jews. In Hebrew, Latin and Greek, so everybody can read it. And when the priests complain, Pilate says: what I have written, I have written.

The soldiers divide His clothes. But His tunic is seamless, woven in one piece from the top. So they roll dice for it. Psalm 22 - they divide My garments and cast lots for My clothing. And the robe of the high priest was woven so it would not tear.

And near the cross stand His mother, and some other women, and the disciple He loved. And with nails through His hands, He takes care of His mother. Woman, behold your son. Son, behold your mother.

Honor your father and your mother. He kept that commandment to His last breath.

Then He says: I am thirsty.

The One who offered living water to a woman at a well. The One who stood up at the feast and shouted, if anyone is thirsty, come to Me and drink. Thirsty.

And they put a sponge full of vinegar on a branch of hyssop and lift it to His mouth.

Hyssop. That is what the Israelites used in Egypt to paint the blood of the lamb on their doorposts. Only John tells you that.

And He says one word. In Greek it is tetelestai. It is finished. It was a word you could write on a bill when it was paid off. Paid in full.

And He bowed His head and gave up His spirit. Nobody took it. He gave it.

And John tells us it was the Preparation Day, and that Sabbath was a special one. A high day. Not the weekly Sabbath - an annual one, the first day of Unleavened Bread. So that week had two Sabbaths in it. And that is how He could be in the heart of the earth three days and three nights, just like He said.

The leaders want the bodies down before the Sabbath. So the soldiers break the legs of the other two. But when they come to Him, He is already dead. So they do not break His legs.

And John says: this happened so the Scripture would be fulfilled. Not one of His bones will be broken. That was the rule for the Passover lamb.

Instead a soldier shoves a spear into His side, and blood and water pour out. And John stops the whole story to tell you: I saw it. I am telling you the truth, so you can believe.

And another Scripture: they will look on Him whom they pierced. Zechariah 12. And in Zechariah, it is Yahweh speaking. They will look to Me, whom they pierced.

And then two men come out of hiding. Joseph of Arimathea, who had been a disciple in secret because he was afraid. And Nicodemus - the one who came by night in chapter 3.

The cross did what three years of miracles could not. It brought them out into the open.

Nicodemus brings about seventy-five pounds of myrrh and aloes. That is a burial for a king. And they wrap Him in linen with the spices and lay Him in a new tomb, in a garden, where no one had ever been laid.

Before we read - stand at the foot of this cross for a minute. Every promise in the first eighteen chapters was leading here. And the last word He said was not help me. It was it is finished.

John 19:1-42 (WEB)

1 So Pilate then took Jesus, and flogged him.

2 The soldiers twisted thorns into a crown, and put it on his head, and dressed him in a purple garment.[1]

3 They kept saying, “Hail, King of the Jews!” and they kept slapping him.

4 Then Pilate went out again, and said to them, “Behold, I bring him out to you, that you may know that I find no basis for a charge against him.”

5 Jesus therefore came out, wearing the crown of thorns and the purple garment. Pilate said to them, “Behold, the man!”[2]

6 When therefore the chief priests and the officers saw him, they shouted, saying, “Crucify! Crucify!” Pilate said to them, “Take him yourselves, and crucify him, for I find no basis for a charge against him.”

7 The Jews answered him, “We have a law, and by our law he ought to die, because he made himself the Son of God.”[3]

8 When therefore Pilate heard this saying, he was more afraid.

9 He entered into the Praetorium again, and said to Jesus, “Where are you from?” But Jesus gave him no answer.[4]

10 Pilate therefore said to him, “Aren’t you speaking to me? Don’t you know that I have power to release you, and have power to crucify you?”

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[1] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 3:17-18 - *the ground cursed for Adam’s sake, yielding thorns and thistles*

[2] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 6:12 • Isaiah 4:2 - *behold, the man whose name is the Branch, who shall build Yahweh’s temple, and Yahweh’s branch beautiful and glorious*

[3] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 24:16 • Deuteronomy 18:20 - *he who blasphemes Yahweh’s name shall surely be put to death, and the prophet who speaks presumptuously in my name shall die*

[4] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:7 • Psalm 38:13-14 - *as a sheep before its shearers is silent he did not open his mouth, and a mute man who does not open his mouth*

11 Jesus answered, “You would have no power at all against me, unless it were given to you from above. Therefore he who delivered me to you has greater sin.”

12 At this, Pilate was seeking to release him, but the Jews cried out, saying, “If you release this man, you aren’t Caesar’s friend! Everyone who makes himself a king speaks against Caesar!”

13 When Pilate therefore heard these words, he brought Jesus out, and sat down on the judgment seat at a place called “The Pavement”, but in Hebrew, “Gabbatha.”

14 Now it was the Preparation Day of the Passover, at about the sixth hour. He said to the Jews, “Behold, your King!”

15 They cried out, “Away with him! Away with him! Crucify him!” Pilate said to them, “Shall I crucify your King?” The chief priests answered, “We have no king but Caesar!”[5]

16 So then he delivered him to them to be crucified. So they took Jesus and led him away.

17 He went out, bearing his cross, to the place called “The Place of a Skull”, which is called in Hebrew, “Golgotha”,[6]

18 where they crucified him, and with him two others, on either side one, and Jesus in the middle.[7]

19 Pilate wrote a title also, and put it on the cross. There was written, “JESUS OF NAZARETH, THE KING OF THE JEWS.”

20 Therefore many of the Jews read this title, for the place where Jesus was crucified was near the city; and it was written in Hebrew, in Latin, and in Greek.

21 The chief priests of the Jews therefore said to Pilate, “Don’t write, ‘The King of the Jews,’ but, ‘he said, “I am King of the Jews.”’”

22 Pilate answered, “What I have written, I have written.”

23 Then the soldiers, when they had crucified Jesus, took his garments and made four parts, to every soldier a part; and also the coat. Now the coat was without seam, woven from the top throughout.[8]

24 Then they said to one another, “Let’s not tear it, but cast lots for it to decide whose it will be,” that the Scripture might be fulfilled, which says, “They parted my garments among them. For my cloak they cast lots.” Therefore the soldiers did these things.[9]

25 But there were standing by the cross of Jesus his mother, and his mother’s sister, Mary the wife of Clopas, and Mary Magdalene.

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[5] **Cross-Reference:** 1 Samuel 8:7 • Judges 8:23 - *they have rejected me as king over them, and Yahweh shall rule over you*

[6] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 22:6 - *Abraham laying the wood of the burnt offering on Isaac his son*

[7] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:12 - *he poured out his soul to death and was counted with the transgressors*

[8] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 28:31-32 • Exodus 39:22 - *the robe of the ephod with a binding of woven work so that it would not be torn, made of woven work*

[9] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 22:18 - *they divide my garments among them, and they cast lots for my clothing*

26 Therefore when Jesus saw his mother, and the disciple whom he loved standing there, he said to his mother, “Woman, behold, your son!”

27 Then he said to the disciple, “Behold, your mother!” From that hour, the disciple took her to his own home.

28 After this, Jesus, seeing that all things were now finished, that the Scripture might be fulfilled, said, “I am thirsty.”[10]

29 Now a vessel full of vinegar was set there; so they put a sponge full of the vinegar on hyssop, and held it at his mouth.[11]

30 When Jesus therefore had received the vinegar, he said, “It is finished.” He bowed his head, and gave up his spirit.

31 Therefore the Jews, because it was the Preparation Day, so that the bodies wouldn’t remain on the cross on the Sabbath (for that Sabbath was a special one), asked of Pilate that their legs might be broken, and that they might be taken away.[12]

32 Therefore the soldiers came, and broke the legs of the first, and of the other who was crucified with him;

33 but when they came to Jesus, and saw that he was already dead, they didn’t break his legs.

34 However one of the soldiers pierced his side with a spear, and immediately blood and water came out.

35 He who has seen has testified, and his testimony is true. He knows that he tells the truth, that you may believe.

36 For these things happened, that the Scripture might be fulfilled, “A bone of him will not be broken.”[13]

37 Again another Scripture says, “They will look on him whom they pierced.”[14]

38 After these things, Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus’ body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body.

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[10] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 69:21 • Psalm 22:15 - *in my thirst they gave me vinegar to drink, and my tongue sticks to the roof of my mouth*

[11] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 12:22 • Psalm 51:7 - *a bunch of hyssop dipped in the blood of the lamb for the doorposts, and purify me with hyssop*

[12] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:6-7 • Deuteronomy 21:22-23 - *the first day of Unleavened Bread a holy convocation with no regular work, and the hanged body not left on the tree overnight*

[13] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Exodus 12:46 • Psalm 34:20 - *do not break any of the lamb’s bones, and he protects all his bones, not one is broken*

[14] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 12:10 - *they will look to me whom they have pierced, and mourn for him as for an only son*

39 Nicodemus, who at first came to Jesus by night, also came bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about a hundred Roman pounds.[15]

40 So they took Jesus' body, and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, as the custom of the Jews is to bury.

41 Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden. In the garden was a new tomb in which no man had ever yet been laid.[16,17]

42 Then because of the Jews' Preparation Day (for the tomb was near at hand) they laid Jesus there.

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[15] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 45:8 - *all your garments smell of myrrh, aloes and cassia*

[16] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:9 - *his grave made with the wicked, and with a rich man in his death*

[17] **Cross-Reference:** Matthew 27:60 • Genesis 2:8 - *laid in Joseph's own new tomb cut out of the rock, and the garden Yahweh God planted in Eden*

CHAPTER 20 - An Empty Tomb Before Dawn, Mary in the Garden, and My Lord and My God

Key Notes

- “On the first day of the week… while it was still dark.” Mary came early and the stone was already gone. Nobody in any Gospel sees the resurrection happen. They find it already done (John 20:1).
- The first day of the week, after the Sabbath, was the day the firstfruits sheaf was waved before Yahweh during Unleavened Bread. Paul calls the risen Messiah the firstfruits of those who are asleep (John 20:1, Leviticus 23:10-11, 1 Corinthians 15:20).
- “They have taken away the Lord out of the tomb.” Her first thought is grave robbery. Nobody expected a resurrection, which is one reason the accounts read as reports rather than inventions (John 20:2).
- The other disciple outran Peter and got there first. John tells on himself - he got there first and waited outside; Peter, being Peter, went straight in (John 20:4-6).
- The linen cloths were lying there, and the cloth that had been on His head was rolled up in a place by itself. Thieves do not unwrap a body and fold the cloth. Lazarus came out still wrapped. Yahshua left the wrappings behind (John 20:5-7, 11:44).
- “He saw and believed.” Before any appearance, before any angel spoke to him, the beloved disciple believed from what was left in the tomb (John 20:8).
- “They still didn’t know the Scripture, that he must rise from the dead.” The Scriptures had said it - you will not let your holy one see corruption, on the third day he will raise us up - and they had not put it together (John 20:9, Psalm 16:10, Hosea 6:2).
- Mary stays when the men go home. She is weeping outside the tomb, and she stoops to look in (John 20:10-11).
- Two angels in white, one at the head and one at the feet of where the body had lain. Over the ark of the covenant, two cherubim faced each other from either end of the mercy seat, and Yahweh said: there I will meet with you (John 20:12, Exodus 25:18-22).
- “Woman, why are you weeping?” asked by the angels and then by Yahshua. Her grief is taken seriously, and questioned (John 20:13, 20:15).
- She supposed Him to be the gardener. It is a garden, and in a sense she was right. The first man was put in a garden to tend it. The last Adam walks in one on the morning of the new creation (John 20:15, Genesis 2:15).
- “Mary.” One word. The good shepherd calls his own sheep by name, and they know his voice (John 20:16, 10:3).
- “Rabboni” means my teacher, a warmer form than Rabbi. John translates it, as he translated Rabbi and Messiah in chapter 1 (John 20:16, 1:38).

- “Don’t hold me” can mean stop clinging to me. She has Him back and does not want to let go. He has somewhere to go and something for her to do (John 20:17).
- “I haven’t yet ascended to my Father.” Many connect this with the firstfruits sheaf, which had to be presented before Yahweh to be accepted. The text says only that He had not yet ascended (John 20:17, Leviticus 23:11).
- “Go to my brothers.” For the first time in this Gospel He calls the disciples brothers. My Father and your Father, my God and your God. The cross made them family (John 20:17, Psalm 22:22).
- Mary Magdalene is the first person in the Gospel to see the risen Lord and the first sent to tell about it. I have seen the Lord (John 20:18).
- That evening the doors were locked for fear. He came and stood in the middle. Locked doors did not keep Him out, and fear did not keep Him away (John 20:19).
- “Peace be to you” was the ordinary greeting, shalom. On that night, from Him, to the men who ran, it was not ordinary at all. He said it twice (John 20:19, 20:21).
- He showed them His hands and His side. The risen body still carries the wounds. Isaiah said: I have engraved you on the palms of my hands (John 20:20, Isaiah 49:16).
- “As the Father has sent me, even so I send you.” Their mission is modeled on His (John 20:21, 17:18).
- “He breathed on them.” The word is the one used when Yahweh God breathed into the man’s nostrils the breath of life, and Ezekiel prophesied to the breath to breathe on the slain so they would live. New creation, in a locked room (John 20:22, Genesis 2:7, Ezekiel 37:9).
- “If you forgive anyone’s sins, they have been forgiven them.” The first thing the risen Lord hands His people is the work of forgiveness. It is where deliverance starts (John 20:23).
- Thomas was not there. Unless I see the print of the nails, and put my hand into His side, I will not believe. He asked for what the others had already been given (John 20:24-25).
- “After eight days” - by their counting, the next first day of the week. He comes again to the same room and goes straight to Thomas (John 20:26).
- He offers Thomas exactly what Thomas demanded, word for word. He had heard every word of the doubt without being in the room (John 20:27, 20:25).
- “My Lord and my God!” is the highest confession in the Gospels, and it comes from the doubter. The psalmist prayed rise up to defend me, my God, my Lord. Yahshua does not correct him (John 20:28, Psalm 35:23).
- The Gospel began with the Word was God and nearly ends with a man calling Him my God. John 1:1 and John 20:28 are the frame of the book (John 20:28, 1:1).
- “Blessed are those who have not seen, and have believed.” That is everyone who has believed since - including everyone reading this (John 20:29).

- “These are written, that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that believing you may have life in his name.” John tells you why he wrote the book. Everything he chose was chosen for this (John 20:30-31).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
The Day After the Sabbath	John 20:1 • Leviticus 23:10-11 • Leviticus 23:15-16
Cherubim at Either End	John 20:12 • Exodus 25:18-20 • Exodus 25:22
The Man in the Garden	John 20:15 • Genesis 2:15 • Genesis 3:8
Called by Name	John 20:16 • Isaiah 43:1 • John 10:3
Your God My God	John 20:17 • Ruth 1:16 • Psalm 22:22
Peace, Peace	John 20:19 • Isaiah 57:19 • Numbers 6:26
Sins Forgiven	John 20:23 • Psalm 32:1-2 • Micah 7:18
Blessed Without Seeing	John 20:29 • Habakkuk 2:4 • Psalm 34:8

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
Not Abandoned to Corruption	John 20:9 • Psalm 16:10 • Hosea 6:2
The Firstfruits	John 20:17 • Leviticus 23:10-11 • 1 Corinthians 15:20
Here I Am, Send Me	John 20:21 • Isaiah 6:8 • Isaiah 61:1
Breath on the Slain	John 20:22 • Ezekiel 37:9-10 • Genesis 2:7
Engraved on the Palms of My Hands	John 20:27 • Isaiah 49:16 • Zechariah 13:6
My God and My Lord	John 20:28 • Psalm 35:23 • Isaiah 9:6

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 20 Commentary (David Guzik) - the empty tomb, Mary Magdalene, the appearance to the disciples, and Thomas
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John’s signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 20A - exposition of the resurrection accounts in John

John 20 - Opening Intro

The first day of the week. It is still dark.

And Mary Magdalene comes to the tomb, and the stone has already been rolled away.

Notice that. Nobody watched it happen. In none of the Gospels does anybody see the resurrection. They show up and find it already done.

And it is the first day of the week, after the Sabbath. During Unleavened Bread, that was the day the priest waved the very first sheaf of the harvest before Yahweh. Firstfruits. And Paul says it plainly: Messiah has been raised from the dead, the firstfruits of those who are asleep.

Mary does not think resurrection. She thinks robbery. She runs to Peter and the other disciple: they have taken the Lord out of the tomb, and we do not know where they put Him.

And the two men run. And John cannot resist telling us - the other disciple ran faster than Peter and got there first. He stoops and looks in. But Peter, being Peter, walks straight in.

And they see the linen cloths lying there. And the cloth that was on His head is not with them. It is rolled up, in a place by itself.

Grave robbers do not unwrap a body and fold the napkin. And remember Lazarus? He came out still wrapped up. Somebody had to unwrap him. Yahshua left the wrappings behind.

And John says: he saw, and believed. Before any angel said a word. Before he saw the Lord. He looked at what was left in that tomb and believed.

The men go home. But Mary stays. She is standing outside the tomb crying. And she bends down and looks in, and there are two angels in white, sitting where His body had been - one at the head, and one at the feet.

Now picture the ark of the covenant. On top of it, the mercy seat. And two cherubim, one at each end, facing each other. And God said: there, between them, I will meet with you.

And here are two angels, one at each end of where the body of Jesus had lain. The mercy seat is empty, and the meeting place is open.

Woman, why are you crying? Because they took my Lord away, and I do not know where they laid Him.

And she turns around and sees a man standing there, and does not recognize Him. She thinks He is the gardener.

And in a way she is right. It is a garden. The first Adam was put in a garden to tend it. And on the first day of the new creation, the last Adam is walking in one.

Sir, if you carried Him off, tell me where, and I will take Him.

And He says one word. Mary.

That is all. Her name. In chapter 10 He said the good shepherd calls his own sheep by name, and they know his voice.

And she turns and says: Rabboni. My Teacher.

And she grabs hold of Him. And He says: stop clinging to Me. I have not yet ascended to My Father. But go to My brothers and tell them: I am ascending to My Father and your Father, to My God and your God.

My brothers. He never called them that before. The men who ran away are now His brothers. And His Father is now their Father.

And Mary goes and tells them. I have seen the Lord.

That evening the disciples are behind locked doors because they are afraid. And Yahshua comes and stands in the middle of them, and says: peace be with you.

Shalom. To the men who ran. To Peter who denied Him. The first word is not where were you. It is peace.

And He shows them His hands and His side. The wounds are still there. Isaiah - I have engraved you on the palms of My hands.

And then: as the Father sent Me, so I send you. And He breathes on them, and says: receive the Holy Spirit.

Breathed. Go back to Genesis 2. Yahweh God formed the man from the dust and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life. And Ezekiel 37 - breath, come and breathe on these dead, so they can live.

In a locked room, full of frightened men, the new creation starts the way the first one did. With His breath.

And the first thing He gives them to do: if you forgive anyone’s sins, they are forgiven. The risen Lord hands His people forgiveness. That is where deliverance begins.

But Thomas was not there. And when they tell him, he says: unless I see the nail marks in His hands and put my finger in them, and put my hand into His side, I will not believe.

Eight days later they are in the room again, Thomas with them. Doors locked. And Yahshua stands in the middle and says: peace be with you. And then He turns straight to Thomas.

Put your finger here. See My hands. Reach out your hand and put it into My side. Do not be unbelieving, but believing.

He offered Thomas the exact words of his own doubt. He was not in the room when Thomas said them. He heard every one.

And Thomas says the greatest confession in the whole Bible. My Lord and my God.

And Yahshua does not correct him. He accepts it.

The book started with: in the beginning was the Word, and the Word was God. And it ends with a doubting man on his knees saying: my God.

And then Yahshua says: you believed because you saw. Blessed are those who have not seen, and yet have believed.

That is you.

And John tells us why he wrote the whole thing. These are written so that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that believing, you may have life in His name.

Before we read - Mary heard her name. Thomas got his proof. The frightened men got peace. He met every one of them exactly where they were. He still does.

John 20:1-31 (WEB)

1 Now on the first day of the week, Mary Magdalene went early, while it was still dark, to the tomb, and saw the stone taken away from the tomb.[18]

2 Therefore she ran and came to Simon Peter, and to the other disciple whom Jesus loved, and said to them, “They have taken away the Lord out of the tomb, and we don’t know where they have laid him!”

3 Therefore Peter and the other disciple went out, and they went toward the tomb.

4 They both ran together. The other disciple outran Peter, and came to the tomb first.

5 Stooping and looking in, he saw the linen cloths lying, yet he didn’t enter in.

6 Then Simon Peter came, following him, and entered into the tomb. He saw the linen cloths lying,

7 and the cloth that had been on his head, not lying with the linen cloths, but rolled up in a place by itself.

8 So then the other disciple who came first to the tomb also entered in, and he saw and believed.

9 For as yet they didn’t know the Scripture, that he must rise from the dead.[19]

10 So the disciples went away again to their own homes.

11 But Mary was standing outside at the tomb weeping. So, as she wept, she stooped and looked into the tomb,

12 and she saw two angels in white sitting, one at the head, and one at the feet, where the body of Jesus had lain.[20]

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[18] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:10-11 • Leviticus 23:15-16 - *the sheaf of firstfruits waved on the day after the Sabbath, and the count of fifty days from that day*

[19] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 16:10 • Hosea 6:2 - *you will not allow your holy one to see corruption, and on the third day he will raise us up*

13 They told her, “Woman, why are you weeping?” She said to them, “Because they have taken away my Lord, and I don’t know where they have laid him.”

14 When she had said this, she turned around and saw Jesus standing, and didn’t know that it was Jesus.

15 Jesus said to her, “Woman, why are you weeping? Who are you looking for?” She, supposing him to be the gardener, said to him, “Sir, if you have carried him away, tell me where you have laid him, and I will take him away.”[21]

16 Jesus said to her, “Mary.” She turned and said to him, “Rabboni!” which is to say, “Teacher!”[22]

17 Jesus said to her, “Don’t hold me, for I haven’t yet ascended to my Father; but go to my brothers, and tell them, ‘I am ascending to my Father and your Father, to my God and your God.’”[23,24]

18 Mary Magdalene came and told the disciples that she had seen the Lord, and that he had said these things to her.

19 When therefore it was evening, on that day, the first day of the week, and when the doors were locked where the disciples were assembled, for fear of the Jews, Jesus came and stood in the middle, and said to them, “Peace be to you.”[25]

20 When he had said this, he showed them his hands and his side. The disciples therefore were glad when they saw the Lord.

21 Jesus therefore said to them again, “Peace be to you. As the Father has sent me, even so I send you.”[26]

22 When he had said this, he breathed on them, and said to them, “Receive the Holy Spirit![27]

23 If you forgive anyone’s sins, they have been forgiven them. If you retain anyone’s sins, they have been retained.”[28]

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[20] **Cross-Reference:** Exodus 25:18-20 • Exodus 25:22 - *two cherubim at the two ends of the mercy seat, and there I will meet with you*

[21] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 2:15 • Genesis 3:8 - *the man put in the garden to cultivate and keep it, and Yahweh God walking in the garden*

[22] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 43:1 • John 10:3 - *I have called you by your name, you are mine, and the shepherd calls his own sheep by name*

[23] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Leviticus 23:10-11 • 1 Corinthians 15:20 - *the sheaf of the firstfruits waved before Yahweh to be accepted, and Messiah raised as the first fruits of those who are asleep*

[24] **Cross-Reference:** Ruth 1:16 • Psalm 22:22 - *your God my God, and I will declare your name to my brothers*

[25] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 57:19 • Numbers 6:26 - *peace, peace, to him who is far off and to him who is near, and Yahweh give you peace*

[26] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 6:8 • Isaiah 61:1 - *whom shall I send, and the anointed one sent to proclaim liberty*

[27] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 37:9-10 • Genesis 2:7 - *breath, breathe on these slain that they may live, and Yahweh God breathing into the man the breath of life*

[28] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 32:1-2 • Micah 7:18 - *blessed is he whose disobedience is forgiven, and who is a God like you, who pardons iniquity*

24 But Thomas, one of the twelve, called Didymus, wasn't with them when Jesus came.

25 The other disciples therefore said to him, "We have seen the Lord!" But he said to them, "Unless I see in his hands the print of the nails, put my finger into the print of the nails, and put my hand into his side, I will not believe."

26 After eight days again his disciples were inside, and Thomas was with them. Jesus came, the doors being locked, and stood in the middle, and said, "Peace be to you."

27 Then he said to Thomas, "Reach here your finger, and see my hands. Reach here your hand, and put it into my side. Don't be unbelieving, but believing."[29]

28 Thomas answered him, "My Lord and my God!"[30]

29 Jesus said to him, "Because you have seen me, you have believed. Blessed are those who have not seen, and have believed."[31]

30 Therefore Jesus did many other signs in the presence of his disciples, which are not written in this book;

31 but these are written, that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that believing you may have life in his name.

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[29] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 49:16 • Zechariah 13:6 - *I have engraved you on the palms of my hands, and the wounds with which he was wounded in the house of his friends*

[30] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 35:23 • Isaiah 9:6 - *rise up to defend me, my God, my Lord, and the son given whose name is Mighty God*

[31] **Cross-Reference:** Habakkuk 2:4 • Psalm 34:8 - *the righteous will live by his faith, and taste and see that Yahweh is good*

CHAPTER 21 - A Night of Catching Nothing, Breakfast on the Beach, and Do You Love Me?

Key Notes

- Chapter 20 ended with a purpose statement that sounds like a conclusion. Chapter 21 reads like an epilogue, added to tell what happened to Peter and to correct a rumor about the beloved disciple (John 21:1, 20:31, 21:23).
- Seven disciples are there, and Nathanael of Cana is named - the man from chapter 1, who has not been mentioned since (John 21:2, 1:45-49).
- “I’m going fishing.” Peter goes back to what he knew before he was called. The others go with him. That night they caught nothing (John 21:3).
- It is the same scene as the day He first called Peter in Luke: a night of nothing, a word to let the nets down, and more fish than the net could hold. He is calling Peter again, the same way (John 21:3-6, Luke 5:5-6).
- “Children, have you anything to eat?” He calls them children, little ones, the way a father would. They answer with one word: no (John 21:5).
- “Cast the net on the right side of the boat.” A hundred yards from shore, on the side they had presumably already tried. The difference was not the location. It was the word (John 21:6).
- “It’s the Lord!” The beloved disciple recognizes Him first; Peter acts first. He throws on his coat and jumps into the water. The two of them, true to form (John 21:7).
- A fire of coals, with fish and bread already on it. The charcoal fire is the same word as the fire in the high priest’s courtyard where Peter denied Him. The only two in the New Testament (John 21:9, 18:18).
- Fish and bread, the same food as the feeding of the five thousand. He takes the bread and gives it to them, and the fish likewise (John 21:9, 21:13, 6:11).
- “Bring some of the fish which you have just caught.” He already has fish on the fire. He asks for theirs anyway. He wants their part in it (John 21:10).
- A hundred and fifty-three large fish, counted. It is the kind of thing a fisherman remembers. Many symbolic readings have been offered; the text offers none. And the net was not torn, though in the earlier catch the nets were breaking (John 21:11, Luke 5:6).
- Ezekiel saw a river flowing from the temple, and fishermen spreading their nets, and fish exceedingly many. The catch is a picture of what the mission will bring in (John 21:11, Ezekiel 47:9-10).
- “Come and eat breakfast.” The risen Lord of all creation cooks breakfast for men who abandoned Him (John 21:12).
- “None of the disciples dared inquire of him, ‘Who are you?’ knowing that it was the Lord.” He is the same and not the same, recognized and yet changed (John 21:12).

- “Simon, son of Jonah” - not Peter, the rock. The name he had before he was called. Three times (John 21:15-17, 1:42).
- “Do you love me more than these?” More than these men, or more than these fish and boats? Peter had once claimed more than the others: even if all fall away, I will not. Now he does not compare himself to anyone (John 21:15, Mark 14:29).
- The WEB shows a change in the Greek. Twice Yahshua asks do you love me, using agapao, and Peter answers I have affection for you, using phileo. The third time Yahshua takes Peter’s own word. Readers debate how much weight to give it, since John uses both words for the Father’s love for the Son (John 21:15-17, 3:35, 5:20).
- Three questions for three denials. He does not skip the wound, and He does not leave it open (John 21:17, 18:17, 18:25, 18:27).
- “Peter was grieved because he asked him the third time.” Restoration can hurt. The grief is part of the healing (John 21:17).
- “Lord, you know everything. You know that I have affection for you.” Peter no longer trusts his own promises. He appeals to what the Lord knows (John 21:17).
- Feed my lambs, tend my sheep, feed my sheep. The man who failed is given the flock. Restoration in this Gospel is not probation; it is a commission (John 21:15-17, 10:11).
- “When you are old, you will stretch out your hands, and another will dress you.” John explains it meant the kind of death by which Peter would glorify God. Early tradition says Peter was crucified in Rome. Peter himself later wrote that the putting off of his tent was near, as the Lord had shown him (John 21:18-19, 2 Peter 1:14).
- “Follow me.” The first words He spoke to His first followers in chapter 1 were come and see; the last words He says to Peter are follow me (John 21:19, 1:39).
- “Lord, what about this man?” Peter, just restored, immediately looks at somebody else’s path. “What is that to you? You follow me” (John 21:21-22).
- A rumor spread that the beloved disciple would not die. John corrects it carefully: Yahshua never said that. He said if I desire that he stay until I come. Even at the end, John insists on exactly what was said (John 21:23).
- “This is the disciple who testifies about these things, and wrote these things. We know that his witness is true.” The beloved disciple is the author, and others vouch for him (John 21:24).
- “Even the world itself wouldn’t have room for the books.” John chose a handful of signs out of a life too large to write down - and chose them so that you might believe (John 21:25, 20:30-31).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Labor in Vain	John 21:3 • Psalm 127:1-2 • Haggai 1:6
At Your Word I Will Let Down the Net	John 21:6 • Luke 5:5-6

Topic	References
The Fire of Coals	John 21:9 • John 18:18
He Took the Bread and Gave It	John 21:13 • John 6:11
Shepherds After My Heart	John 21:15 • Jeremiah 3:15 • Ezekiel 34:2
Confessing and Finding Mercy	John 21:17 • Proverbs 28:13 • Psalm 51:12
The Putting Off of My Tent	John 21:18 • 2 Peter 1:14
He Arose and Followed	John 21:19 • 1 Kings 19:20-21

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
Fish Exceedingly Many	John 21:11 • Ezekiel 47:9-10 • Jeremiah 16:16
He Will Feed His Flock	John 21:15 • Isaiah 40:11 • Ezekiel 34:23
He Restores My Soul	John 21:17 • Psalm 23:3 • Isaiah 57:18
Until I Come	John 21:22 • Zechariah 14:5 • Malachi 3:1
You Are My Witnesses	John 21:24 • Isaiah 43:10 • Isaiah 44:8

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 21 Commentary (David Guzik) - the miraculous catch, breakfast by the sea, and the restoration of Peter
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 21 - exposition of the epilogue and Peter's restoration

John 21 - Opening Intro

Chapter 20 ended like the book was over. These are written that you may believe. But John has one more story to tell, because Peter's story is not finished.

Seven disciples are by the Sea of Galilee. And Peter says: I am going fishing.

And you can hear it in that sentence. Back to the boat. Back to what he knew before. Maybe after what he did in that courtyard, he figured that was all he was good for.

And the others go with him. And they fish all night and catch nothing.

Some of you know exactly what that night feels like.

At dawn there is a man standing on the shore, and they do not recognize Him. And He calls out: children, have you caught anything? And they say: no.

And He says: throw the net on the right side of the boat, and you will find some.

And they do, and they cannot haul it in for the number of fish.

Now, has this happened before? Yes. Luke 5. The very first time Yahshua called Peter. Master, we worked all night and caught nothing - but at Your word I will let down the net. And the nets started breaking.

He is calling Peter again. The same way He called him the first time.

And the disciple Jesus loved says: it is the Lord! And Peter grabs his coat and jumps into the sea.

John recognizes Him first. Peter gets there first. Same two men as at the tomb.

And when they get to shore, there is a charcoal fire, with fish and bread on it.

A charcoal fire. The last time Peter stood by a charcoal fire, he said I do not know Him. Three times. That word only shows up twice in the whole New Testament - at the fire of denial, and here.

Yahshua builds Peter a fire just like the one where he failed. Because He is about to heal it.

And He says: bring some of the fish you just caught. He already has fish cooking. He asks for theirs anyway. He wants them to have a part in it.

And Peter drags the net in. A hundred and fifty-three big fish. And the net did not break. A fisherman counts that and remembers the number the rest of his life.

And Yahshua says: come and have breakfast.

The risen Lord of creation, cooking breakfast on a beach for the men who ran away from Him.

And after breakfast, He turns to Peter. Simon, son of Jonah. Not Peter. Not the rock. The name he had before.

Do you love Me more than these?

Remember, Peter once said: even if everybody else falls away, I will not. More than these. Now he does not compare himself to anybody. He just says: Yes Lord, You know I have affection for You.

And your WEB actually shows you something here. Yahshua asks do you love Me, with the big word for love. And Peter answers: I have affection for You. A smaller word. He will not promise more than he has anymore.

Feed My lambs.

Second time. Simon, son of Jonah, do you love Me? Lord, You know I have affection for You. Tend My sheep.

Third time. And this time Yahshua uses Peter's word. Simon, do you have affection for Me?

And John says Peter was grieved because He asked him a third time.

Three times. One for every denial. And it hurt. Restoration sometimes hurts, because He does not skip the wound. But He does not leave it open either.

And Peter says: Lord, You know everything. You know I have affection for You.

He is done trusting his own promises. He just throws himself on what the Lord knows.

Feed My sheep.

The man who failed Him is handed the flock. That is not probation. That is a commission.

Then Yahshua tells Peter how he will die. When you were young, you dressed yourself and went where you wanted. When you are old, you will stretch out your hands, and someone else will dress you and take you where you do not want to go. And the history that comes down to us says Peter was crucified.

And then two words. Follow Me.

And Peter - just restored, ten seconds ago - turns around and looks at John and says: Lord, what about him?

And Yahshua says: if I want him to stay until I come, what is that to you? You follow Me.

Some of us spend so much time looking at somebody else's path that we forget the two words He said to us.

And John ends by saying: this is the disciple who wrote these things, and we know his testimony is true. And there were so many other things Yahshua did that if every one were written down, the world itself could not hold the books.

Before we read - if you have a charcoal fire in your past, a place where you said I do not know Him, He is not avoiding it. He is building a fire just like it on the beach, and cooking you breakfast, and asking you one question. Do you love Me?

John 21:1-25 (WEB)

1 After these things, Jesus revealed himself again to the disciples at the sea of Tiberias. He revealed himself this way.

2 Simon Peter, Thomas called Didymus, Nathanael of Cana in Galilee, and the sons of Zebedee, and two others of his disciples were together.

3 Simon Peter said to them, "I'm going fishing." They told him, "We are also coming with you." They immediately went out, and entered into the boat. That night, they caught nothing.[32]

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[32] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 127:1-2 • Haggai 1:6 - *unless Yahweh builds the house they labor in vain, and you have sown much and bring in little*

4 But when day had already come, Jesus stood on the beach, yet the disciples didn't know that it was Jesus.

5 Jesus therefore said to them, "Children, have you anything to eat?" They answered him, "No."

6 He said to them, "Cast the net on the right side of the boat, and you will find some." They cast it therefore, and now they weren't able to draw it in for the multitude of fish.[33]

7 That disciple therefore whom Jesus loved said to Peter, "It's the Lord!" So when Simon Peter heard that it was the Lord, he wrapped his coat around him (for he was naked), and threw himself into the sea.

8 But the other disciples came in the little boat (for they were not far from the land, but about two hundred cubits away), dragging the net full of fish.

9 So when they got out on the land, they saw a fire of coals there, and fish laid on it, and bread.[34]

10 Jesus said to them, "Bring some of the fish which you have just caught."

11 Simon Peter went up, and drew the net to land, full of great fish, one hundred fifty-three; and even though there were so many, the net wasn't torn.[35]

12 Jesus said to them, "Come and eat breakfast." None of the disciples dared inquire of him, "Who are you?" knowing that it was the Lord.

13 Then Jesus came and took the bread, gave it to them, and the fish likewise.[36]

14 This is now the third time that Jesus was revealed to his disciples, after he had risen from the dead.

15 So when they had eaten their breakfast, Jesus said to Simon Peter, "Simon, son of Jonah, do you love me more than these?" He said to him, "Yes, Lord; you know that I have affection for you." He said to him, "Feed my lambs."[37,38]

16 He said to him again a second time, "Simon, son of Jonah, do you love me?" He said to him, "Yes, Lord; you know that I have affection for you." He said to him, "Tend my sheep."

17 He said to him the third time, "Simon, son of Jonah, do you have affection for me?" Peter was grieved because he asked him the third time, "Do you have affection for me?" He said to him, "Lord, you know everything. You know that I have affection for you." Jesus said to him, "Feed my sheep.[39,40]

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[33] **Cross-Reference:** Luke 5:5-6 - *we worked all night and took nothing, but at your word I will let down the net, and the net was breaking*

[34] **Cross-Reference:** John 18:18 - *the fire of coals in the high priest's courtyard where Peter stood warming himself*

[35] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 47:9-10 • Jeremiah 16:16 - *fishermen spreading nets where the river flows and fish exceedingly many, and I will send for many fishermen*

[36] **Cross-Reference:** John 6:11 - *Jesus took the loaves, gave thanks, and distributed them, and likewise the fish*

[37] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 40:11 • Ezekiel 34:23 - *he will feed his flock like a shepherd, and one shepherd set over them who will feed them*

[38] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 3:15 • Ezekiel 34:2 - *shepherds according to my heart who feed you with knowledge, and shouldn't the shepherds feed the sheep*

18 Most certainly I tell you, when you were young, you dressed yourself, and walked where you wanted to. But when you are old, you will stretch out your hands, and another will dress you, and carry you where you don't want to go."[41]

19 Now he said this, signifying by what kind of death he would glorify God. When he had said this, he said to him, "Follow me."[42]

20 Then Peter, turning around, saw a disciple following. This was the disciple whom Jesus loved, the one who had also leaned on Jesus' breast at the supper and asked, "Lord, who is going to betray You?"

21 Peter seeing him, said to Jesus, "Lord, what about this man?"

22 Jesus said to him, "If I desire that he stay until I come, what is that to you? You follow me."[43]

23 This saying therefore went out among the brothers, that this disciple wouldn't die. Yet Jesus didn't say to him that he wouldn't die, but, "If I desire that he stay until I come, what is that to you?"

24 This is the disciple who testifies about these things, and wrote these things. We know that his witness is true.[44]

25 There are also many other things which Jesus did, which if they would all be written, I suppose that even the world itself wouldn't have room for the books that would be written.

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[39] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 23:3 • Isaiah 57:18 - *he restores my soul, and I have seen his ways, and will heal him and restore comforts to him*

[40] **Cross-Reference:** Proverbs 28:13 • Psalm 51:12 - *whoever confesses and renounces his sins finds mercy, and restore to me the joy of your salvation*

[41] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Peter 1:14 - *the putting off of my tent comes swiftly, as our Lord made clear to me*

[42] **Cross-Reference:** 1 Kings 19:20-21 - *Elisha leaving the oxen and running after Elijah, and then he arose and went after him*

[43] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 14:5 • Malachi 3:1 - *Yahweh my God will come, and all the holy ones with you, and the Lord whom you seek will suddenly come*

[44] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 43:10 • Isaiah 44:8 - *you are my witnesses, says Yahweh, and is there a God besides me*

Major Themes Across John 19-21

- Thorns from the curse, worn as a crown by the one who came to lift it
- Behold the man, a pagan governor quoting Zechariah without knowing it
- The Lamb examined three times and found without defect
- Power over Him given only from above
- We have no king but Caesar, from the men who led Yahweh's worship
- The Son carrying the wood up the hill, as Isaac did
- A sign in three languages telling the truth Pilate would not stand for
- A seamless tunic, woven like the robe of the high priest
- A mother given a son from the cross
- The giver of living water, thirsty
- Hyssop, the plant that marked the Passover blood on the doorposts
- It is finished: paid in full
- A spirit given up, not taken
- A special Sabbath, and two Sabbaths in one week
- Not a bone broken, like the Passover lamb
- They will look on Him whom they pierced, spoken by Yahweh of Himself
- Secret disciples brought into the open by the cross
- A king's burial in a new tomb in a garden
- A tomb found already empty, before dawn, on the day of firstfruits
- Grave clothes left lying, and a head cloth folded by itself
- Two angels at the head and feet, like the cherubim of the mercy seat
- The last Adam mistaken for the gardener
- One word, her name, and she knew His voice
- Brothers for the first time, and a Father shared
- Peace spoken first to the men who ran
- Wounds still carried by the risen body
- Breath on the disciples as on the first man and Ezekiel's slain
- Forgiveness handed over first, where deliverance begins
- The doubter's exact words offered back to him
- My Lord and my God: the frame of the book closing
- Blessed are those who have not seen
- A night of nothing and a word from the shore

- Two charcoal fires, denial and restoration
- Breakfast cooked by the risen Lord
- Three questions for three denials
- Restoration that is a commission, not a probation
- What is that to you? You follow Me

Benediction

Let this be the word that goes before us tonight:

May we behold the Man, and see who He really is.

May we never trade our King for any Caesar.

May we carry what He gives us to carry, as He carried the wood.

May we care for the people He has given us, even in our suffering.

May we rest in the word it is finished.

May we look on Him whom they pierced, and mourn, and be healed.

May the cross bring every hidden disciple into the open.

May we come early, while it is still dark, and find the stone already rolled away.

May we see what He left behind, and believe.

May we hear Him call our name in the garden.

May we let go of what we cling to, and go and tell.

May we receive His peace behind every locked door.

May we be sent as He was sent.

May His breath make us new.

May we forgive, and be the first to set others free.

May every doubt be answered by His wounds.

May we say with Thomas, my Lord and my God.

May we be blessed among those who have not seen and yet believe.

May we have life in His name.

May we cast the net at His word after a night of nothing.

May we recognize Him on the shore.

May we meet Him at a charcoal fire and be restored.

May we answer, Lord, You know everything.

May we feed His lambs and tend His sheep.

May we glorify Him in life and in death.

May we follow Him, and stop asking about anyone else’s path.

May every promise He has spoken over us stand up, come forth, and manifest in its appointed time.

Amen.